similar to that of the Taj itself[12], and perhaps not coincidentally, if the designs of Humayun's Tomb and Jahangir's mausoleum were combined and constructed out of white marble, it would form the basic outline of the Taj.

Together, all of these predecessors show how local and foreign influences regarding designs, architecture, and the importance of tombs all combined to help inspire and guide the designers of the Taj. Indeed, the combined Persian-cum-Mughal style of shrine-like mausoleums evolved into the full-blown Mughal charbagh that saw its ultimate expression in the creation of the Taj Mahal. To recognize how these cultural traditions eventually flowed into the masterpiece is not to diminish the genius of the work but to understand how the broader social and cultural histories inevitably influenced art and artists. [13]